STANDARD FORM NO. 64

[redacted]

A/B, 1, 8/4

(4.)

Office Memorandum • UNITED STATES GOVERNMENT

TO G · Chief [redacted] Administration & Logistics

DATE: 21 November 1952

FROM G : [redacted] Division Logistics

65p

SUBJECT: Sodium Pentothal

97

1. Below is information requested concerning the possible methods of neutralizing the effects of Sodium Pentothal.

2. The class of drugs known as the "Central Nervous System Stimulates" will, to a limited extent, counter-act the effects of Sodium Pentothal. Some of these are: Benzedrine, Dexadrine, Picrotoxin, Caffeine Sodium Benzoate, and Strychnine. These drugs have, however, certain limitations which more or less preclude their successful application in clandestine type activities. Such limitations are as follows:

a. They must be administered just before or just after receiving Sodium Pentothal. This would be difficult to accomplish as it is doubtful that the agent would have the necessary beforehand knowledge of his treatment nor would he be allowed to administer himself during treatment.

b. Such drugs would have to be secreted on the person and administered (such as pills) externally. It is believed that a thorough search of the agent would disclose any such secreted drugs.

c. A physician administering Sodium Pentothal would continue to inject Sodium Pentothal until the patient evidenced the desired reaction; therefore, it would not be possible for the agent to consume enought Central Nervous System Stimulates to neutralize an excessive amount of Sodium Pentothal and still remain alive.

3. Modern psychiatry regularly employs in therapy such tools as narcosynthysis which involves the use of truth serums such as Sodium Pentothal and Sodium Amytol. Use of these drugs in psychiatric treatment is limited as they merely enable the physician and patient to explore more easily materiel in the forgotten unconscious of the patient; such treatment is usually long term therapy. Further, many psychiatrists and criminologists have reported value received from the use of truth serums as often negative. The reason for this is that if the subject has exceptionally strong inhibitions concerning certain material, truth serums are not powerful enough to cause him to divulge the inhibited material. In view of the forgoing, it is believed that if agents were well versed in their cover and the security of such cover, that it would be exceedingly difficult to extract sensitive information from Them while under the influence of truth serums.

[redacted]

4. It is recommended that the foregoing information not be accepted as fact, but that a requirement be presented OTS for a reasearch project to investigate the problem of neutralizing the effects of truth serums. A [redacted] of ADCS/MO has indicated his willingness to aid [redacted] in the G preparation of such a requirement.

5. Your comments are requested concerning paragraph 4 above.

A [redacted]

LP/bhd

[redacted]

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H ROUTINE OR 263 220500Z LA OTG 221730Z

OK NR 228 TO WASHINGTON FM LOS ANGELES

A TO FOR SCIENTIFIC FROM SF BRANCH - CITE LA-3298

C RE CASE 13184 RPT 13184,

C IS THOROUGHLY INFORMED
ABOUT LAD 25 RPT LAD 25 AND ITS EFFECTS ON HUMANS. FOUR YEAR STUDY BY THEM AT
B INVOLVING THIRTY-FIVE HUMAN VOLUNTEERS WILL
C BE IN MONOGRAPH [illegible] FORM THIS SUMMER (1954 RPT 1954). HAS COMPLETE
INTERNATIONAL BIBLIOGRAPHY AND COLLECTION OF PAPERS ON LAD 25 RPT LAD 25.
MONOGRAPH WITH CONCLUSIONS CAN BE [illegible] COMPLETED PRIOR TO PUBLICA-
C TION. BIBLIOGRAPHICAL MATERIALS CAN BE MICROFILMED [illegible]. IS ALSO WILLING
C TO TALK TO [illegible]LOGICAL SPECIALIST FROM AGENCY, IF DESIRED.

C WEST COAST REPRESENTATIVE OF SANDOZ RPT SANDOZ (450 RPT 450 SUTTER
B STREET, SAN FRANCISCO) IS ALSO INFORMED ON LAD 25 RPT LAD 25.

BC AT

BC HAVE ALSO BEEN WORK-
C ING WITH DRUG.
D (HAS
C WRITTEN SHORT DESCRIPTIVE ARTICLE. APPEARS TO BE AS FULLY INFORMED
AS ANYONE IN US RPT US. HE [illegible] HE GOT INFORMATION FROM BEHIND THE LINES
OF [illegible] BY [illegible] RPT [illegible] SCIENTIST [illegible] RPT [illegible] AT [illegible] [illegible]
C PHYSIOLOGICAL CONGRESS [illegible] KNOW ALL ABOUT [illegible]. HAS
HUNGARIANS AND POLLACKS [illegible] [illegible]. HE BELIEVES THEY ARE COUPLE [illegible]
AHEAD OF US RPT US [illegible]. [illegible] 25 RPT [illegible] 25
A [illegible]!

LA TOT: 22/1800Z

RCVD TOT: 23/1330Z

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